



Top 38 CAT Critical Reasoning Questions With Video Solutions

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Questions

Instructions

For the following questions answer them individually

Question 1

Aspiration is nothing new. Neither is the debate over what the Indian middle class is, what it wants and what it buys. Since the mid-80s, that has been the focus of the economic policy papers so called pro- and anti-poor budgets and marketing strategies that have successfully broken the barrier of urban selling and reached deeper into rural India with increasing income levels and aspirations. Based on the above passage, it can be inferred that

- A the Indian middle class has been the focus of economic policies for a long time.
- B the Indian middle class has graduated from being the 'deprived' middle class to the 'pampered' middle class.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

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Question 2

From Cochin to Shimla, the new culture vultures are tearing down acres of India's architectural treasures. Ancestral owners are often fobbed off with a few hundred rupees for an exquisitely carved door or window, which fetches fifty times that much from foreign dealers, and yet more from the drawing room sophisticates of Europe and the US. The reason for such shameless rape of the Indian architectural wealth can perhaps, not wrongly, be attributed to the unfortunate blend of activist disunity and the local indifference. It can be inferred from the above passage that

- A the environment created by the meeting between activist disunity and local indifference is ideal for antique dealers to thrive in India.
- B only Indians are not proud of their cultural heritage and are hungry for the foreign currency that is easily available in return of artifacts.
- C most Indian families have heirlooms which can be sold at high prices to Europeans and Americans.
- D India provides a rich market for unscrupulous antique dealers.

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Question 3

Deepa Metha's Fire is under fire from the country's self-appointed moral police. Their contention is that the film is a violation of the Indian cultural mores and cannot be allowed to influence the Indian psyche. According to them, such films ruin the moral fabric of the nation, which must be protected and defended against such intrusions at all cost, even at the cost of cultural dictatorship.

Based on the information in the above passage, it can be inferred that

- A the assumption underlying the moral police's critique of Fire is that the Indian audience is vulnerable to all types of influence.

- B** the assumption underlying the moral police's critique of Fire is that the Indian audience is impressionable and must be protected against 'immoral' influences.
- C** the moral police thinks it has the sole authority to pass judgement on films screened in India.
- D** None of these

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Question 4

According to McNeill, a Brahmin priest was expected to be able to recite at least one of the Vedas. The practice was essential for several centuries when the Vedas had not yet been written down. It must have had a selective effect, since priests would have been recruited from those able or willing to memorize long passages. It must have helped in the dissemination of the work, since a memorized passage can be duplicated many times.

Which one of the following can be inferred from the above passage?

- A** Reciting the Vedas was a Brahmin's obligation.
- B** The Vedic priest was like a recorded audio cassette.
- C** McNeill studied the behaviour of Brahmin priests.
- D** Vedic hymns had not been scripted.

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Question 5

Argentina's beef cattle herd has dropped to under 50 million from 57 million ten years ago in 1990. The animals are worth less, too: prices fell by over a third last year, before recovering, slightly. Most local meat packers and processors are in financial trouble, and recent years have seen a string of plant closures. The Beef Producers' Association has now come up with a massive advertisement campaign calling upon Argentines to eat more beef—their "juicy, healthy, rotund, plate-filling" steaks.

Which one of the following, if true, would contribute most to a failure of the campaign?

- A** There has been a change in consumer preference towards eating leaner meats like chicken and fish.
- B** Prices of imported beef have been increasing, thus making locally grown beef more competitive in terms of pricing.
- C** The inability to cross breed native cattle with improved varieties has not increased production to adequate levels.
- D** Animal rights pressure groups have come up rapidly, demanding better and humane treatment of farmyard animals like beef cattle.

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Question 6

The offer of the government to make iodised salt available at a low price of one rupee per kilo is welcome, especially since the government seems to be so concerned about the ill effects of non-iodised salt. But it is doubtful whether the offer will actually be implemented. Way back in 1994, the government, in an earlier effort, had prepared reports outlining three new and simple but experimental methods for reducing the costs of iodisation to about five paise per kilo. But these reports have remained just those — reports on paper.

Which one of the following, if true, most weakens the author's contention that it is doubtful whether the offer will be actually implemented?

- A The government proposes to save on costs by using the three methods it has already devised for iodisation.
- B The chain of fair-price distribution outlets now covers all the districts of the state.
- C Many small-scale and joint-sector units have completed trials to use the three iodisation methods for regular production.
- D The government which initiated the earlier effort is in place even today and has more information on the effects of non-iodised salt.

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Question 7

In a recent report, the gross enrolment ratios at the primary level, that is, the number of children enrolled in classes one to five as a proportion of all children aged 6 to 10, were shown to be very high for most states; in many cases they were way above 100 percent! These figures are not worth anything, since they are based on the official enrolment data compiled from school records. They might as well stand for 'gross exaggeration ratios'.

Which of the following options best supports the claim that the ratios are exaggerated?

- A The definition of gross enrolment ratio does not exclude, in its numerator, children below 6 years or above 10 years enrolled in classes one to five.
- B A school attendance study found that many children enrolled in the school records were not meeting a minimum attendance requirement of 80 percent.
- C A study estimated that close to 22 percent of children enrolled in the class one records were below 6 years of age and still to start going to school.

- D Demographic surveys show shifts in the population profile which indicate that the number of children in the age group 6 to 10 years is declining.

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Question 8

The problem of traffic congestion in Athens has been testing the ingenuity of politicians and town planners for years. But the measures adopted to date have not succeeded in decreasing the number of cars on the roads in the city centre. In 1980, an odds and evens number-plate legislation was introduced, under which odd and even plates were banned in the city centre on alternate days, thereby expecting to halve the number of cars in the city centre. Then in 1993 it was decreed that all cars in use in the city centre must be fitted with catalytic converters; a regulation had just then been introduced, substantially reducing import taxes on cars with catalytic converters, the only condition being that the buyer of such a 'clean' car offered for destruction a car at least 15 years old.

Which one of the following options, if true, would best support the claim that the measures adopted to date have not succeeded?

- A In the 1980s, many families purchased second cars with the requisite odd or even number plate.
- B In the mid-1990s, many families found it feasible to become first-time car owners by buying a car more than 15 years old and turning it in for a new car with catalytic converters.
- C Post-1993, many families seized the opportunity to sell their more than 15 year-old cars and buy 'clean' cars from the open market, even if it meant forgoing the import tax subsidy.
- D All of the above.

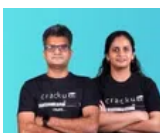
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Question 9

Efficiency is all right in its place, in the shop, the factory, the store. The trouble with efficiency is that it wants to rule our play as well as our work; it won't be content to reign in the shop, it follows us home. It can be inferred from the above passage that

- A efficiency can become all-pervading.
- B efficiency does not always pay.
- C efficiency can be more of a torture than a blessing.
- D None of these

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Question 10

The company's coffee crop for 1998-99 totalled 8079 tonnes, an all time record. The increase over the previous year's production of 5830 tonnes was 38.58%. The previous highest crop was 6089 tonnes in 1970-71. The company had fixed a target of 8000 tonnes to be realized by the year 2000-01, and this has been achieved two years earlier, thanks to the emphasis laid on the key areas of irrigation, replacement of unproductive coffee

bushes, intensive refilling and improved agricultural practices. It is now our endeavour to reach the target of 10000 tonnes in the year 2001-02. Which one of the following would contribute most to making the target of 10000 tonnes in 2001-02 unrealistic?

- A The potential of the productivity enhancing measures implemented up to now has been exhausted.
- B The total company land under coffee has remained constant since 1969 when an estate in the Nilgiri Hills was acquired.
- C The sensitivity of the crop to climatic factors makes predictions about production uncertain.
- D The target-setting procedures in the company have been proved to be sound by the achievement of the 8000 tonne target.

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Question 11

Three airlines - IA, JA and SA - operate on the Delhi-Mumbai route. To increase the number of seats sold, SA reduced its fares and this was emulated by IA and JA immediately. The general belief was that the volume of air travel between Delhi and Mumbai would increase as a result. Which of the following, if true, would add credence to the general belief?

- A Increase in profitability of the three airlines.
- B Extension of the discount scheme to other routes.
- C A study that shows that air travellers in India are price-conscious.
- D A study that shows that as much as 80% of air travel in India is company-sponsored.

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Question 12

Whether we look at the intrinsic value of our literature, or at the particular situation of this country, we shall see the strongest reason to think that of all foreign tongues, the English tongue is that which would be the most useful to our native subjects. It can be inferred that

- A the speaker is a die-hard colonist.
- B the speaker has the good of the nation at heart.
- C the speaker is addressing an issue related to a colonial empire.
- D None of these

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Question 13

The company encourages its managers to interact regularly, without a pre-set agenda, to discuss issues concerning the company and society. This idea has been borrowed from the ancient Indian concept of religious congregation, called satsang. Designations are forgotten during these meetings; hence, it is not uncommon in

these meetings to find a sales engineer questioning the CEO on some corporate policy or his knowledge of customers. Based on the information provided in the above passage, it can be inferred that

- A the company is concerned about its reputation with its employees.
- B the company believes in fostering the spirit of dialogue without degenerating it into a positioning based debate.
- C the company had some inter-personnel problems in the past due to which it felt the need for these corporate satsangs.
- D All of these

 VIEW SOLUTION

Question 14

Szymanski suggests that the problem of racism in football may be present even today. He begins by verifying an earlier hypothesis that clubs' wage bills explain 90% of their performance. Thus, if players' salaries were to be only based on their abilities, clubs that spend more should finish higher. If there is pay discrimination against some group of players — fewer teams bidding for black players thus lowering the salaries for blacks with the same ability as whites — that neat relation may no longer hold. He concludes that certain clubs seem to have achieved much less than what they could have, by not recruiting black players.

Which of the following findings would best support Szymanski conclusions?

- A Certain clubs took advantage of the situation by hiring above-average shares of black players.
- B Clubs hired white players at relatively high wages and did not show proportionately good performance.
- C During the study period, clubs in towns with a history of discrimination against blacks, under-performed relative to their wage bills.
- D Clubs in one region, which had higher proportions of black players, had significantly lower wage bills than their counterparts in another region which had predominantly white players.



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 VIDEO SOLUTION

Question 15

Animals in general are shrewd in proportion as they cultivate society. Elephants and beavers show the greatest signs of this sagacity when they are together in large numbers, but when man invades their communities they lose all their spirit of industry. Among insects, the labours of the bee and the ant have attracted the attention and admiration of naturalists, but all their sagacity seems to be lost upon separation, and a single bee or ant seems destitute of every degree of industry. It becomes the most stupid insect imaginable, and it languishes and soon dies.

Which of the following can be inferred from the above passage?

- A Humankind is responsible for the destruction of the natural habitat of animals and insects.
- B Animals, in general, are unable to function effectively outside their normal social environment.
- C Naturalists have great admiration for bees and ants, despite their lack of industry upon separation.
- D Elephants and beavers are smarter than bees and ants in the presence of human beings.

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Smarter groups

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Question 16

Developed countries have made adequate provisions for social security for senior citizens. State insurers (as well as private ones) offer medicare and pension benefits to people who can no longer earn. In India, with the collapse of the joint family system, the traditional shelter of the elderly has disappeared. And a State faced with a financial crunch is not in a position to provide social security. So, it is advisable that the working population give serious thought to building a financial base for itself.

Which one of the following, if it were to happen, weakens the conclusion drawn in the above passage the most?

- A The investable income of the working population, as a proportion of its total income, will grow in the future.
- B The insurance sector is underdeveloped and trends indicate that it will be extensively privatized in the future.
- C India is on a path of development that will take it to a developed country status, with all its positive and negative implications.
- D If the working population builds a stronger financial base, there will be a revival of the joint family system.

VIEW SOLUTION

Question 17

Cigarettes constitute a mere 20% of tobacco consumption in India, and fewer than 15% of the 200 million tobacco users consume cigarettes. Yet these 15% contribute nearly 90% of the tax revenues to the Exchequer from the tobacco sector. The punitive cigarette taxation regime has kept the tax base narrow, and reducing

taxes will expand this base.

Which one of the following best bolsters the conclusion that reducing duties will expand the tax base'?

- A The cigarette manufacturers' association has decided to indulge in aggressive promotion.
- B There is a likelihood that tobacco consumers will shift to cigarette smoking if cigarette prices were to reduce.
- C The cigarette manufacturers are lobbying for a reduction on duties.
- D An increase in duties on non-cigarette tobacco may lead to a shift in favour of cigarette smoking.

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Question 18

Thomas Malthus, the British clergyman turned economist, predicted that the planet would not be able to support the human population for long. His explanation was that human population grows at a geometric rate, while the food supply grows only at an arithmetic rate.

Which one of the following, if true, would not undermine the thesis offered by Malthus?

- A Population growth can be slowed down by the voluntary choices of individuals and not just by natural disasters.
- B The capacity of the planet to feed a growing human population can be enhanced through biotechnological means.
- C Human systems, and natural systems like food supply, follow natural laws of growth which have remained constant, and will remain unchanged.
- D Human beings can colonize other planetary systems on a regular and on-going basis to accommodate a growing population.

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Question 19

Although in the limited sense of freedom regarding appointments and internal working, the independence of the Central Bank is unequivocally ensured, the same cannot be said of its right to pursue monetary policy without co-ordination with the central government. The role of the Central Bank has turned out to be subordinate and advisory in nature.

Which of the following best supports the conclusion drawn in the passage?

- A A decision of the chairman of the Central Bank to increase the bank rate by two percentage points sent shock-waves in industry, academic and government circles alike.
- B Government has repeatedly resorted to monetisation of the debt despite the reservations of the Central Bank.
- C The Central Bank does not need the central government's nod for replacing soiled currency notes.
- D The inability to remove coin shortage was a major shortcoming of this government.

Question 20

The theory of games is suggested to some extent by parlour games such as chess and bridge. Friedman illustrates two distinct features of these games. First, in a parlour game played for money, if one wins the other (others) loses (lose). Second, these games are games involving a strategy. In a game of chess, while choosing what action is to be taken, a player tries to guess how his/her opponent will react to the various actions he or she might take. In contrast, the card-pastime, 'patience' or 'solitaire' is played only against chance.

Which one of the following can best be described as a "game"?

- A The team of Tenzing Norgay and Edmund Hillary climbing Mt. Everest for the first time in human history.
- B A national level essay writing competition.
- C A decisive war between the armed forces of India and Pakistan over Kashmir.
- D Oil Exporters' Union deciding on world oil prices, completely disregarding the countries which have at most minimal oil production.

Question 21

The dominant modern belief is that the soundest foundation of peace would be universal prosperity. One may look in vain for historical evidence that the rich have regularly been more peaceful than the poor, but then it can be argued that they have never felt secure against the poor; that their aggressiveness stemmed from fear; and that the situation would be quite different if everybody were rich. It can be inferred from the above passage that

- A a lot of aggression in the world stems from the desire of the haves to defend themselves against the have-nots.
- B universal prosperity as a foolproof measure of peace can no longer be accepted.
- C Both a and b
- D Neither a nor b

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**Question 22**

About 96% of Scandinavian moths have ears tuned to the ultrasonic pulses that bats, their predators, emit. But the remaining 4% do not have ears and are deaf. However, they have a larger wingspan than the hearing moths, and also have higher wing-loadings the ratio between a wing's area and its weight — meaning higher maneuverability.

Which one of the following can be best inferred from the above passage?

- A A higher proportion of deaf moths than hearing moths fall prey to bats.
- B Deaf moths may try to avoid bats by frequent changes in their flight direction.

- C Deaf moths are faster than hearing moths, and so are less prone to becoming a bat's dinner than hearing moths.
- D The large wingspan enables deaf moths to better receive and sense the pulses of their bat predators.

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Question 23

Various studies have shown that our forested and hilly regions and, in general, areas where biodiversity—as reflected in the variety of flora—is high, are the places where poverty appears to be high. And these same areas are also the ones where educational performance seems to be poor. Therefore, it may be surmised that, even disregarding poverty status, richness in biodiversity goes hand in hand with educational backwardness.

Which one of the following statements, if true, can be said to best provide supporting evidence for the surmise mentioned in the passage?

- A In regions where there is little variety in flora, educational performance is seen to be as good as in regions with high variety in flora, when poverty levels are high.
- B Regions which show high biodiversity also exhibit poor educational performance, at low levels of poverty.
- C Regions which show high biodiversity reveal high levels of poverty and poor educational performance.
- D In regions where there is low biodiversity, at all levels of poverty, educational performance is seen to be good.

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Question 24

The effect produced on the mind by travelling depends entirely on the mind of the traveller and on the way in which he conducts himself. The chief idea of one very common type of traveller is to see as many objects of interest as he possibly can. If he can only after his return home say that he has seen such and such temple, castle, picture gallery, or museum, he is perfectly satisfied. Far different is the effect of travels upon those who leave their country with a mind prepared by culture to feel intelligent admiration for all the beauties of nature and art to be found in foreign lands. When they visit a new place, instead of hurrying from temple to museum to picture gallery, they allow the spirit of the place to sink into their minds, and only visit such monuments as the time they have at their disposal allows them to contemplate without irreverent haste.

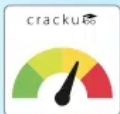
It can be inferred from the above passage that

- A the writer prefers the second type of traveller.
- B the first type of traveller is the lay traveller who does not understand the worth of any place he travels to.
- C the objective of the second type of traveller is not to see much, but to see well.
- D All of these

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Question 25

The pressure on Italy's 257 jails has been increasing rapidly. These jails are old and overcrowded. They are supposed to hold up to 43,000 people -9,000 fewer than now. San Vittore in Milan, which has 1,800 inmates, is designed for 800. The number of foreigners inside jails has also been increasing. The minister in charge of prisons fears that tensions may snap, and so has recommended to the government an amnesty policy.

Which one of the following, if true, would have most influenced the recommendation of the minister?

- A Opinion polls have indicated that many Italians favour a general pardon.
- B The opposition may be persuaded to help since amnesties must be approved by a two-thirds majority in parliament.
- C During a recent visit to a large prison, the Pope, whose pronouncements are taken seriously, appealed for 'a gesture of clemency.'
- D Shortly before the recommendation was made, 58 prisons reported disturbances in a period of two weeks.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 26

Where the film Bombay loses out is where every commercial film congenitally goes awry — becoming too simplistic to address serious issues and failing to translate real life to reel. Which of the following can be inferred from the above line?

- A The film's director aimed at recreating real life on the silver screen.
- B The film was too simplistic for the audience's taste.
- C The film was successful in spite of its shortcomings.
- D None of these

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 27

In order to ease the traffic congestion, the transport planners decided to have a sophisticated system of elevated monorail travel in the city. However, it was pointed out by somebody that a metro rail system would be a more effective solution to the traffic problem. The plan was thus stalled. Moreover, since a budget had not been drawn up for the project, it was deemed fit to stall the work of the monorail for some time. In the meanwhile, the traffic planners of the city decided to build an efficient system of subways and flyovers in the city with the aim of easing the same problem. At the instant when the planners were preparing to award the contracts to the concerned parties, the transport planners came up with the contention that the subways interfered with the site of a pillar of the monorail system. The traffic planners had to give up the idea and think of other possible solutions.

Which of the following can we infer from the above passage?

- A The city authorities felt that the monorail system was essentially impractical.
- B There is a strong contention between the two groups of planners in the city.
- C The projects would be stalled for an indefinite period.
- D None of these

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Instructions

It is sometimes mooted that there can be democracy in a two party system. That would be correct if politics were a game like cricket or football; but politics is not sports.

Question 28

Which of the following would strengthen the argument?

- A Two party system functions well
- B Politics is a dirty game.
- C Two political parties limit the choice of the voters.
- D None of these.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 29

The assumption/assumptions of the argument is/are which of the following?

I. Politics is not a game.

II. Two party system is ideal for democracy.

III. Cricket is played by two teams.

- A Only I
- B Only II
- C Only III
- D I, II, III

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 30

Which of the following would weaken the argument?

- A The game of politics is played like any other game, for example, football.
- B Politics is not a sport.
- C Political parties struggle for power.
- D None of these.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

We have planned development with a view to raising standard of living of our teeming millions. Hence our economic development is inspired by social justice.

Question 31

Which of the following will weaken the argument?

- A Without economic development standard of living cannot be raised.
- B Social justice implies economic prosperity.
- C Development cannot be planned.
- D None of these.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 32

Which of the following will strengthen the argument?

- A Social justice can be done by raising the standard of living
- B Economic planning is necessary for every state.
- C For economic development production should be increased.
- D None of these.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 33

The argument is based on which of the following assumptions?

- I. Social justice is our aim and economic development is the means.
- II. There is overpopulation in India.
- III. Economic development will lead to social justice.

- A Only I
- B Both I and II
- C Both I and III
- D Both II and III

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Instructions

We will have to take more interest in hydro-electric projects. As the prices of oil have increased, it has become vital that such renewable sources of energy are tapped.

Question 34

Which of the following will weaken the argument?

- A Generation of hydroelectric power is more costly than oil.
- B OPEC increased oil prices.
- C Without energy we cannot manage.
- D None of these.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

Question 35

The assumption/assumptions of the argument is /are which of the following?

- I. Hydro electric power is a renewable source of energy.
- II. Hydro electric power is comparatively cheaper.

- A Only I
- B only II
- C Both I and II
- D Neither I nor II

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Instructions

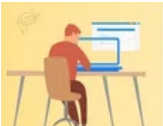
There can be no civilization without music, dance or art, for one is not fully, vibrantly alive without them.

Question 36

Which of the following would weaken the argument?

- A Music is the life of man.
- B Living persons like music.
- C Art has no relation with civilization.
- D None of these.

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Question 37

Which of the following would strengthen the argument?

- A Music, dance and art are human activities.

- B** Only the vibrantly alive can contribute to civilization.
- C** Music injects new life in man.
- D** None of these.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

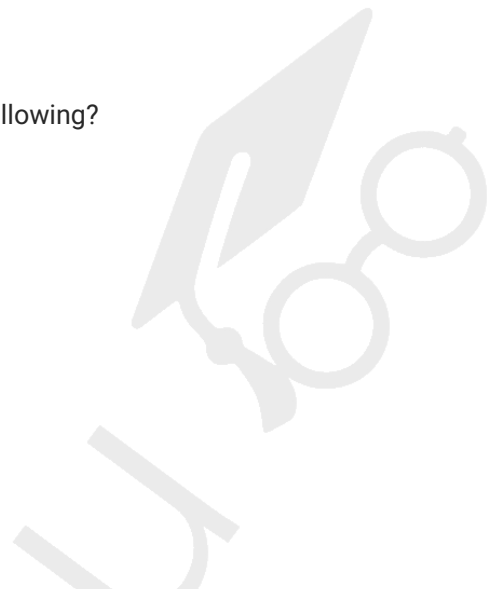
Question 38

The assumption/assumptions of the argument is /are which of the following?

- A. Civilization and art are closely linked up.
- B. If people are not full of life there can be no civilization.

- A** Only I
- B** Only II
- C** Both I and II
- D** Neither I nor II.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



Answers

1.A	2.A	3.B	4.B	5.A	6.C	7.C	8.D
9.A	10.A	11.C	12.D	13.B	14.B	15.B	16.C
17.B	18.C	19.B	20.C	21.A	22.B	23.D	24.C
25.D	26.D	27.C	28.C	29.C	30.A	31.C	32.A
33.C	34.A	35.B	36.C	37.B	38.B		

Explanations

1. A

There is nothing in the passage to suggest that the Indian middle class has been transformed to a 'pampered' middle class. Options b) and c) are incorrect. However, the paragraph strongly suggests that the Indian middle class has been the focus of the economic policies of the Government for a long time now. So, option a) can be inferred.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

2. A

Option b) is incorrect because it says 'only' India is not proud of its culture, which is incorrect.

Option c) is incorrect because we cannot infer if 'most' Indian families have sold off their heirlooms.

Option d) is incorrect because the market is US and Europe and not India. India is the source.

Option a) can be inferred.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

3. B

According to the paragraph, the moral police thinks that the movies are bound to affect the judgment of Indian audience and hence they need to censor the movie in order to preserve their already existing judgment and protect them from the influence of such a work.

Option B correctly summarizes the inference.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

4. B

The paragraph states that a memorized passage could be duplicated multiple times. Thus, we can infer that a Vedic priests memory was as reliable as an audio tape. Thus, option B can be inferred from the paragraph.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

5. A

The campaign can fail badly if the Association is not able to convince the target audience to consume more beef. This can happen if the consumers have changed their lifestyle and prefer eating leaner meats. So, a) is the best reason why the campaign might fail.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)



6.C

If there is evidence that the earlier proposal had been put into practice and not just remained a proposal on paper, then the contention of the author that the new proposal will also remain a proposal on paper is weakened. This is captured by the statement in option c), which says that many small-scale and joint-sector units have completed trials to use the three iodisation methods for regular production. This weakens the author's contention.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

7.C

Let's comprehend the given information first. The ratio of the number of children from classes one to five to all children aged 6 to 10 is very high, often greater than 1. This is the premise. The author says that it is not a valid report as the data is based on official enrolment data compiled from school records and therefore is exaggerated. This is the conclusion.

Here, the assumption is that the enrolment data in school records is often not correct. In order to strengthen the argument, we need to bolster the assumption.

Now, let's check each option to determine the option that strengthens the assumption.

The first option is the definition of gross enrolment ratio. This statement gives the reason for the high gross enrolment ratios. Hence it is strengthening the premise and weakening the conclusion. Therefore, option A is wrong.

The passage does not talk about the attendance of the students and also attendance is not related to the gross enrolment ratio. Option B does not strengthen the argument. Hence, option B is wrong.

Option C says that 22 percent of the children who do not belong to the age group 6-10 and who have not started going to school but have enrolled in class one are included in the numerator of the ratio. This explains why the ratio is high. Also, the ratio is clearly exaggerated as the students have not started going to school yet. Therefore, option C is the answer as it explains why the ratios are exaggerated.

The decline in the number of children in the age group 6 - 10 has nothing to do with the gross enrolment ratio. Hence, option D is wrong.

Therefore, the answer is option C.

 VIEW SOLUTION

8.D

According to the given information, all the three options a), b) and c) have led to an increase in the number of cars in the city.

So, the government's attempts at reducing the number of cars in the city have not succeeded.

Therefore, the answer is d) all the above.

 VIEW SOLUTION

9.A

The author is of the opinion that one cannot limit efficiency to just work. It tends to affect a person's non-work life as well. In other words, efficiency can become all-pervading. Option a) is the correct answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

10.A

The main conclusion of the paragraph is that the company can continue to improve its coffee yield as it has done in the past. The underlying assumption is that the techniques used by them to improve the yield in the past would continue working in the future. Option A refutes this assumption and hence does most to weaken the argument.



11. **C**

The stated conclusion is that volume of air travel will increase if the airfare drops. The underlying assumption is that the travellers decide whether or not to fly based on the cost of the ticket. Option C bolsters the assumption and hence supports the conclusion.

Option D weakens the argument as if travellers are not paying for their ticket, they will not be price-sensitive. The extension of the scheme to other routes or airline profitability does not necessarily reflect on how the scheme is doing over the given route.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

12. **D**

Option a) is incorrect because we cannot infer that the speaker is a colonist. The speaker could be a neutral observer. So, we cannot say that he has the good of the nation at heart. English is not an issue that is related only to the colonial empire. We cannot infer the statement in option c) also.

Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

13. **B**

From the argument, we understand the following points: 1. The company is trying to instill the spirit of dialogue in its employees. 2. This dialogue is agnostic of position or title of the employee.

So, we can infer that the company believes in fostering the spirit of dialogue without degenerating it into a positioning based debate. Option B is the correct answer.

In option C, there is an assumption that the company had some inter-personal problems in the past. However, there is no such information in the passage from which we can infer the assumption. Also, we have to choose the answer according to the contents of the given paragraph. Therefore, option C is incorrect.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

14. **B**

It is given that 90 percent of a club's performance can be explained by wage bills. If a player's salary is based on only on their abilities then the clubs that paid more amounts must finish higher. This relation will not hold true if there is pay discrimination. The conclusion of the passage is that certain clubs seem to have achieved less than they could have, by not recruiting black players.

Here, the assumption is that certain clubs paid more than many other clubs but did not finish at a position they could have had.

Now, let's check each option and verify whether it strengthens Szymanski's conclusions.

Option A is not relevant here because it does not address our assumption in any way. Hence, option A is wrong.

The clubs that the author is talking about could have chosen a few black players, paid the black players lower wages and achieved as much as they did now. So, if it is a fact that clubs hired white players at relatively high wages and did not show proportionately good performance, then we can conclude that these clubs achieved less than they could have had. Hence, option B is correct.

According to option C, the towns have a history of discrimination against blacks. But, the clubs might or might not show the discrimination. Hence, the underperformance of these clubs cannot strengthen Szymanski's conclusions. Therefore, option C is wrong.

Option D is a fact which can be deduced from the information given in the passage. Hence, it doesn't strengthen the conclusion.

Therefore, option B is the correct answer.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

15. **B**

From the options given, we can eliminate options C and D as they are unsupported by the facts given in the paragraph. Option A is not an inference that can be built from the information given in the paragraph.

The paragraph states that animals, from elephants and beavers down to the bee, lose their spirit and intelligence when they are separated from the communities and their environments are invaded by humans. Hence, option B directly follows from this premise.

 VIDEO SOLUTION

100+ CAT Quant Questions



16. **C**

The main conclusion of the paragraph is that the working population should save for its future given that the Indian state is not in a position to provide social security for its citizens. The underlying assumption is that the Indian state would not be in a position to provide social security even in the future. If option C is true, then this assumption is attacked and the conclusion is weakened.

 VIEW SOLUTION

17. **B**

The stated conclusion is that the tax base will increase if the taxes levied on cigarettes is reduced. The underlying assumption is that tobacco users who are not smoking cigarettes will shift to cigarettes if the taxes on them decrease. Option B supports this assumption and hence gives credence to the conclusion.

 VIEW SOLUTION

18. **C**

Options A, B and D offer explanations on how human population can survive. Hence, they undermine the stated conclusion.

The stated conclusion is that human population cannot last long on this planet. The underlying assumption is that what has been observed till now will continue in the future. Hence, option C bolsters this assumption and add credence to the main conclusion.

 VIEW SOLUTION

19. **B**

Among all the options, the only statement where there is a clash between the ideology of the Central Bank and the ideology of the Government is option b), the Government resorting to monetisation despite the reservations of the Central Bank. Hence, option b) is the answer.

 VIEW SOLUTION

20. **C**

According to the passage, one opponent must lose in a game. In option A, no one loses.

Option D is irrelevant.

Option B does not involve strategies.

Only option C fits to be the answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT DILR Questions



21. **A**

The sentence in option b) is opposite to what the argument is conveying.

Option a) can be inferred. According to the argument, a lot of aggression has stemmed because the rich want to defend themselves against the poor. In other words, the aggression has stemmed from the desire of the haves to defend themselves against the have-nots.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

22. **B**

The deaf moths have all the abilities for better maneuverability - for frequent changes in flight direction. So, deaf moths may try to avoid their predators by frequently changing their flight patterns. Option b) is the correct inference.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

23. **D**

The stated conclusion is that richness in biodiversity goes hand in hand with educational backwardness. The underlying assumption is that in areas with low biodiversity, the educational performance is better. As option D bolsters this assumption, it strengthens the conclusion.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

24. **C**

According to the passage, the latter kind of travelers only visit such monuments as the time they have at their disposal allows them to contemplate without irreverent haste.

A is incorrect as the preference of the writer is not the main subject of focus.

B is way too harsh. This cannot be inferred from the passage.

C correctly describes the second kind of travelers.

Thus, C is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

25. **D**

The reason for the minister to advance his new recommendation is most likely because of an incident or incidents which might have occurred in the prisons due to snapping of tensions among the prisoners. This reason is best captured in option d), which says that disturbances have been reported in 58 prisons.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

100+ CAT VARC Questions



26. **D**

Option a) is incorrect because 'translating from real life to reel' is the opinion of the author of the paragraph and not necessarily the opinion of the director. Similarly, option b) also cannot be inferred. There is nothing in the paragraph from which we can infer whether the movie was a success or a failure. Option d) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

27. **C**

Option A cannot be inferred as it is nowhere mentioned. Option B is not necessarily true. The two groups may not agree to each others plans even if they are friendly with each other. Thus, just from the fact that they opposed each others plans we cannot infer that there is contention between the two groups. From the paragraph, we can infer that neither of the two groups can proceed i.e. neither the traffic planners nor the transport planners can move ahead with any plan. Thus, both the parties are dead-locked. Hence, we can infer option C.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

28. **C**

In this paragraph, the author compares the politics with the game like cricket or football and wants to conclude there can be no democracy in 2 party system. Option C strengthens the fact as if it was true than the two party system in a democracy would not be good as it limits the choice of voters.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

29. **C**

That politics is not a game is mentioned in the premise. The premise says that there can be democracy in a two party system if it is like a game like Cricket. It underlying assumption is that Cricket is a game played by two teams. So, only III is a valid assumption. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

30. **A**

The contention of the argument is that there cannot be democracy in a two party system because politics is game unlike the other traditional games. So, if it is true that even politics is played like other games, then the argument is weakened. Option a) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

CAT Expected Questions PDF



31. **C**

According to the premise, the raising of the standards of living of our teeming millions (social justice) is done by planning the economic development. But, if the development cannot be planned, then the argument will be weakened. Option c) is the correct answer.

[VIEW SOLUTION](#)

32. **A**

In this para, the end goal of the author is social justice and economic development is the means to it. "Raising the standard of living" means "developing the economy." Hence Option A strengthens the argument.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

33. **C**

Refer to the last sentence: "Hence our economic development is inspired by social justice." Here the author mentions that when economic development will take place then social justice will happen. Sentence 3 is substantiated.

In this passage, the author wants to promote economic development to achieve social justice. Hence social justice is an end and economic development is the means.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

34. **A**

The argument is built on the assumption that generation of hydroelectric power is cheaper than oil. So, if it is true that generation of hydroelectric power is more expensive than generation of power using oil, the argument will be weakened. Option a) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

35. **B**

Statement 1 is a fact stated in the premise. The author says that "it has become vital that such renewable sources of energy are tapped." while referring to hydroelectric power. As the information is given in the premise, it is not an assumption but an explicitly stated fact.

Also the author states that the price of the oil has been increasing and that's why we have to tap hydroelectric power. The author has assumed that the hydroelectric power is cheap and renewable. Hence, statement 2 is an assumption made by the author.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)



36. **C**

According to the argument, one is vibrantly alive because of music, dance etc. and a civilization is possible only because of the vibrantly alive. So, if it is true that art has no relation with civilization, the argument will be weakened. Option c) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

37. **B**

According to the argument, one is vibrantly alive because of music, dance etc. and a civilization is possible only because of the vibrantly alive. So, the statement that "Only the vibrantly alive can contribute to civilization" would strengthen the argument. Option b) is the correct answer.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)

38. **B**

In these lines the author states that if one is not fully vibrant then there can be no civilization. Hence B is an assumption. A cannot be concluded as we cannot say that the civilization and art are closely related to each other. According to the argument it is just one of the condition for the civilization to exist. It does not suggest that they are closely linked up.

 [VIEW SOLUTION](#)